

Metropolitan Plan Commission, March 5th, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Wbs-terjVFQ
Publication Date	2026-03-06T11:29:53Z
Target Category	delaware_county

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Delaware Muncie Metropolitan Plan Commission Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: March 2026 (Regular Monthly Meeting)

Report Prepared By: Expert Civic Analyst

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presided over by President Chris Smith, the regular meeting of the Delaware Muncie Metropolitan Plan Commission was called to order at [00:00:08](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Tom Borchers, Stephen Brand, Nate Carroll, Jerry Dishman, Richard Ivy, Owen Lecher, Jesse Landis, Ricky Sipe, and Chris Smith.
 - **Members Absent:** Teresa Hensley, Emily Kring, and Adam Leech.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Chris Smith (President).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened at **00:00:13** with the recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance. Members were reminded by Stephen Brand to ensure their microphones were turned on during roll call.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** **00:01:25** The board reviewed the minutes from the February 2026 meeting. Following a motion and second, a roll call vote was conducted:
 - **Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously (8 yes votes recorded from Brand, Carroll, Dishman, Ivy, Landis [noted as Lashae in roll call transcript], Landis, Sipe, and Smith).
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:03:04 Item Identifier & Title:** MPC 02-26Z (Jurisdiction: County Commissioners)
 - **Nature of Request:** An appeal filed by Amvets Muncie Post 12 Inc. requesting a change in zone for property located at 7621 North State Road 3, Muncie, Indiana. The request proposes shifting from a split zone of II (Intense Industrial), BC (Community Business), and F (Farming) to strictly F (Farming) and BC (Community Business) zones.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Kathy Van Ice (Ashton Land Surveyor) and Steve Wilder (Amvets representative).
 - **Deliberation Summary:**
 - The applicant explained that the goal is to resolve a split-zoning issue across the single parcel to allow the construction of a 100 ft by 50 ft picnic/event shelter structure (with an approximate 20-ft peak height and removable/roll-down gray panels for seasonal use) behind the existing BC-zoned area.
 - The project utilizes an existing blacktopped drive and established parking areas.
 - Board members discussed event types (noting past concerts, community gatherings, and 4th of July fireworks), safety/egress, structural design, and drainage (noting an existing retention pond handles runoff adequately). Commissioners noted the proposal represents an improvement to the property that fits harmoniously with the surroundings.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None recorded during the public hearing portion.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously (Favorable recommendation approved by roll call vote: 8-0, with votes recorded from Carroll, Dishman, Ivy, Borchers, Landis, Sipe, Brand, and Smith). Forwarded to the County Commissioners for final action on March 16.
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5. Legislative Action Updates

- **00:14:51 MPC 01-26Z:** Staff reported on a prior legislative action involving an appeal by Hunter Family Irrevocable Grantor Trust and Honey Rock Farms regarding property at 12049 South County Road 349 East. The request changed a split R3/Farming zone to strictly Farming. Following a favorable recommendation by the board on February 5, the County Commissioners approved and adopted the change on February 16.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **Building Commissioner Report:** 106 building permits and 204 inspections have been completed so far in 2026.
 - **MPO & Federal Planning Funds:** The MPO office submitted the Unified Planning Work Program document to the Federal Highway Administration. The fiscal year 2027 PL distribution allotment for county planning reimbursements was announced at \$251,859.72.
 - **New Site Plan Review Reporting:** Staff introduced a new reporting table highlighting daily site plan, landscape, sign, and wireless communication tower reviews. A total of 23 reviews have been conducted in 2026, alongside 6 BZA cases, 4 plan commission cases, and 4 plat committee cases.
 - **Community & Board Events:**
 - Commissioner Brand and Mayor Ridenhour delivered the "State of Our Community" presentation earlier in the day.
 - President Chris Smith's upcoming presentation is scheduled for March 20th (noted as sold out in person, but accessible via live stream through Ball State media).
 - Employees will attend the IDEA conference on March 7th and the American Planning Association Indiana Chapter Spring Conference on March 13th.
 - **Technology Upgrade:** The board noted an operational milestone this meeting marked the inaugural run of a newly established live stream setup by Kyle Johnson, which broadcasts the internal meeting room monitors and split-screen camera feeds directly to the public stream.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned at **00:24:23** by Voice Vote.
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